

Sounding the Alarm on an Epidemic Hiding in Plain Sight.

Seizing the Moment & Building the Movement to Fight It.

DRAFT June 5, 2026 — *Confidential*

A film became a book. A book became a movement.

This work did not start out chasing a market opportunity. It was an obligation.

Boulder tech-turned-social entrepreneur, **Jay Crain kept having the same conversations over and over with midlife friends** – around physical and mental health, careers and relationships, the stress and fear of facing their own mortality while caring for aging parents, and particularly around a loss of identity. At their core, they are all thinking about not just where, but who they are.

GRINTA! film began as a midlife project for Jay and his wife Donna, and ended up screening for thousands across the globe including being an official selection at BANFF Mountain Film Festival. The tale of a pro cyclist who **recovered his identity** to win a stage of the Tour de France inspired the name of the **Grinta For Life (G4L)** program because grit and determination are at its core.

Grinta For Life (G4L) is based on Jay's lived experience of recovering from a dire health situation by first **reconnecting with his identity** as an athlete. Then going on to help and coach others. The book is part memoir/part program built on the expertise of Dr. Greg Welk and his lifetime of teaching, publishing, research, and delivering public health programs. **The G4L Platform** will allow the framework to scale to an entire community that helps many more.

Founders

A combination of **vision**, **unique experience**, and **audacity** focused on a public health crisis for this and future generations of fellow Midlifers.

From tech to social entrepreneur

Jay Crain

THE BUILDER

- Lifelong entrepreneur who pioneered: software for The Macintosh pre-launch, performance fabrics for the golf apparel industry, and a mobile app for field service
- CEO and CMO
- Executive Producer, GRINTA! Film
- Author, *Grinta for Life*
- Architect of the 4R framework, lived it 4x

A life's work in the science of wellness

Dr. Greg Welk

THE SCIENTIST

- Professor of Kinesiology, Iowa State University
- Lifestyle medicine, behavioral, and public health expert
- Corporate wellness consultant
- Author, *Concepts of Fitness and Wellness*
- Anchors the framework with science-based principles and leads the research

The Problem

Midlife identity loss is a **public health catastrophe disguised as a phase of life.**

It's estimated that **35 million of the 105 million Americans between the ages of 40 and 65** have lost the sense of who they are and they're paying for it with their health and, sometimes, their lives. Peer-reviewed research has validated **this epidemic as measurable and real.**

At the current rate, the **U.S. life expectancy ranking is projected to FALL** to 66th globally by 2050. Plus,

500K+

midlife deaths of despair
last 20 years, 5th highest
cause in US

=15

cigarettes per day—
public health risk
of loneliness

>12

year gap in the US
between lifespan
and healthspan

+2.5x

US midlife mortality rate
vs. peer countries

How it Happens

Identity loss in midlife accumulates through life disruptions – doors that open, then close behind you.

The Fade. Eight doors. *Same outcomes.*

Somewhere along the way, who you know you are is diminished by life and others' needs and expectations.

The Career Cliff—*the role that ended, plateaued, or retirement that turned into a freefall.*

The Empty Nest—*the house that got quiet when the kids left*

The Body—*that started saying no to what it used to do easily*

The Marriage—*that drifted from partnership into coexistence*

The Aging Parents – *the role reversal that makes you a primary caregiver*

The Vanishing—*the friendships that quietly disappeared*

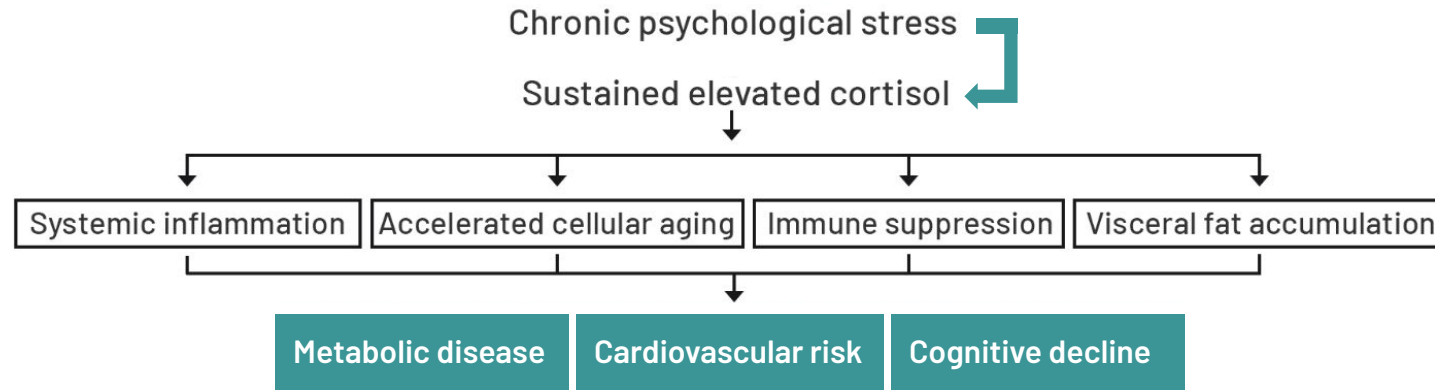
The Diagnosis—*that forced a mirror moment you couldn't avoid*

The Loss—*the death of someone close that changed everything*

How Midlife Identity Loss Impacts the Body & Mind

While we're living longer, **we're sicker than ever.**

When you feel purposeless, disconnected from your body, or stuck in unfulfilling roles, your body interprets this as an **existential threat**. The cortisol stays up. The inflammation compounds. The body pays. And the outcome is dangerous.



Our Mission

Launch Grinta for Life as a social enterprise helping thousands of Midlifers.

We will:

- Directly impact *ten thousand midlifers* to align their health and happiness to their lifespan
- Create & share *one thousand stories* to celebrate success and encourage and motivate others
- Inspire *fifty thousand*, there is a ripple effect, when one makes positive change, it impacts up to 5 more

The Opportunity

105 million Midlife Americans are an **affluent but overlooked and underserved** market.

The wellness economy is \$6.8 trillion and growing—outpacing **sports, tourism, and tech**. Midlifers are more invested in wellness than ever before. We're **addressing a public health crisis and the root cause of midlife identity loss for this market** while everyone else is treating symptoms.

The Midlife Market is An Economic Powerhouse

The midlife audience for G4L is the dominant economic force in American consumer spending. **Consumers over 50:**

\$15 trillion
in purchasing power

control **50%** of
all consumer spending

83% of
household wealth

The average net worth of a U.S. midlifer is \$1.5M, but only 10% of advertisements feature someone over 50.

Our Approach

Guide midlifers to extending their healthspan through an **innovative, wellness-driven business model** combining a program anchored in the **science of Self-Determination Theory** and principles of **Motivational Interviewing**, Jay's **real-life experience** and Greg's **lifetime of work**, harnessing the **power of AI**, delivered in a **community that gets them**.

Two-part Path to Delivery

GRINTA! Impact Campaign – the mission engine.

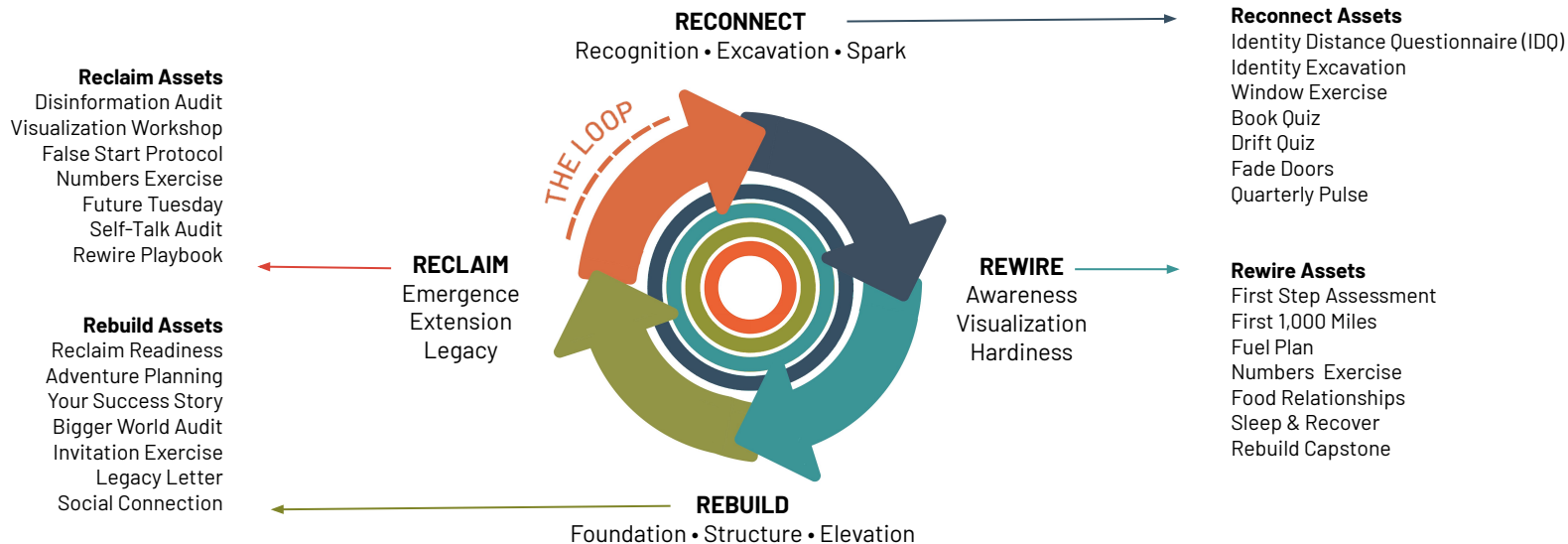
Roadshow/screenings, build in public with Jay going back through the framework himself alongside the charter members, framework validation (Dr. Greg Welk's IRB-certified research). Funded charitably, tax-deductible via UFC.

G4L Platform Development – the product engine.

The member dashboard, the two agents, the technical build – becoming the durable subscription business. Funded commercially, revenue-share into Adjacent Lab LLC.

Proprietary Subscription Platform & Pioneering Longitudinal Research

G4L program operationalizes a 4R (Reconnect, Rewire, Rebuild, Reclaim) framework—28 assets with progress tracked by the **Identity Distance Questionnaire (IDQ)**.



[GO TO FULL PROGRAM AND SCIENCE REFERENCE](#)

Research

Bridging a gap: G4L community will support **first-of-a-kind research** through a longitudinal study based on IRB-certified surveys. It can have **lasting social impact** and **unlock opportunities** to partner with universities and foundations.

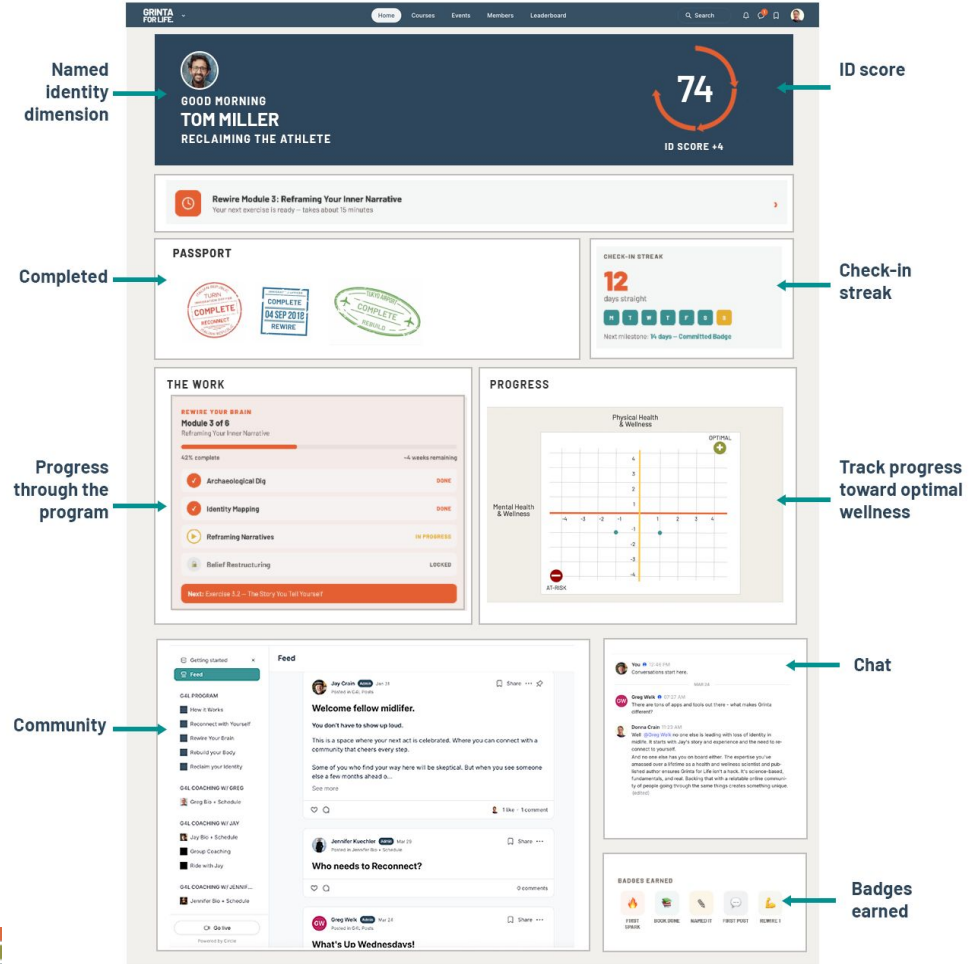
What the Member Sees

The web-based dashboard is the G4L members' homebase with entry points into the community, the "always on" member agent, and all program content. It shows progress so **reclaiming identity** isn't abstract, it shows up in life, and on the screen.

Identity Distance (ID Score) is the dashboard hero metric that **drives member retention** and serves as the longitudinal instrument that **fuels the Research Layer**.

Midlifers seek social connection in online communities. The loneliness epidemic is one of the primary drivers of despair in midlife. The community offers support, accountability, and connection through meaningful interactions with people going through the same things, providing support alongside relatable and informative content.

Community is a compounding asset that fosters recurring engagement, creates feedback loops, and trust-building user-generated content. It will create advocates that reduce churn and CAC through word-of-mouth referrals. And this lucrative demographic is attractive to sponsors too.



How We'll Build It

Engineering tech that scales with the voice of a friend who's been through it.

G4L started with Jay helping friends and family hands-on. Tech will scale with AI agents to extend Jay's voice and reach to members in a way that continues to **feel personal**. Conversations replace filling out forms and worksheets. Feedback and next steps are delivered instantly.

Technology handles reach; humans handle depth. That balance is the product.

G4L is a purpose-built platform with two AI agents engineered specifically for this problem — a member-facing companion that holds each member's full history, and a founder-voice agent that drafts Jay's correspondence — running on a structured data architecture with governance and privacy built in from the start.

A published AI Governance Framework sets the guardrails: members always know they're talking with AI, it never diagnoses or pathologizes, every message in Jay's name is reviewed before it sends, crisis disclosures route to real help, and member data stays protected.

Carefully-designed application of AI makes human connection continuous, personal, and measurable at a scale a small team couldn't otherwise reach. Shaped by the Charter Member Group's real use, the same platform can later run as private, self-contained versions for a company — engineered in from the start, switched on only when a customer funds it.

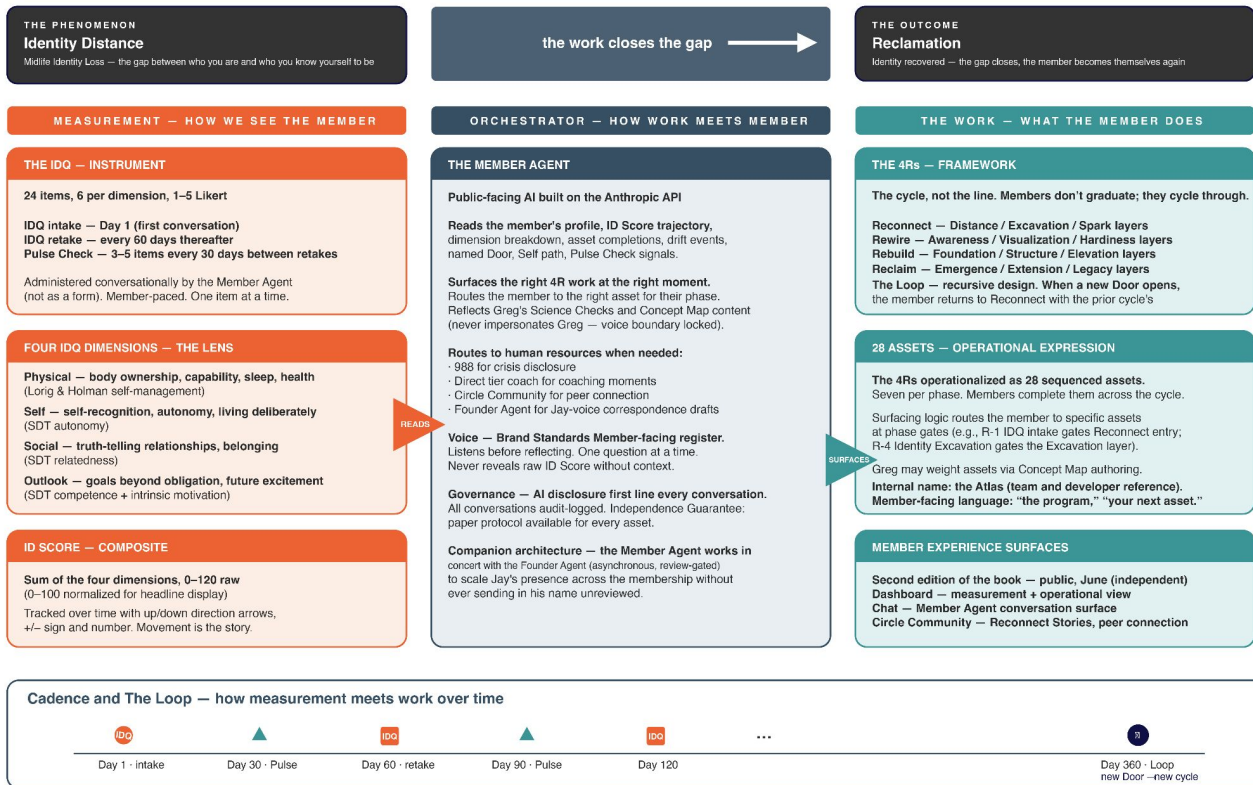
Conceptual Architecture

The IDQ is the tool. The four dimensions are the lens. The “4Rs” is the path.

This is how Grinta for Life

actually works. We measure how far a member has drifted from themselves — the IDQ, scored across four dimensions — then the Member Agent uses that score to guide them, while the 4Rs framework and its assets take the member through exercises, quizzes and assessments that do the work of closing the gap, turning Identity Distance into Reclamation, cycle after cycle.

[CLICK FOR EXPANDED VIEW](#)

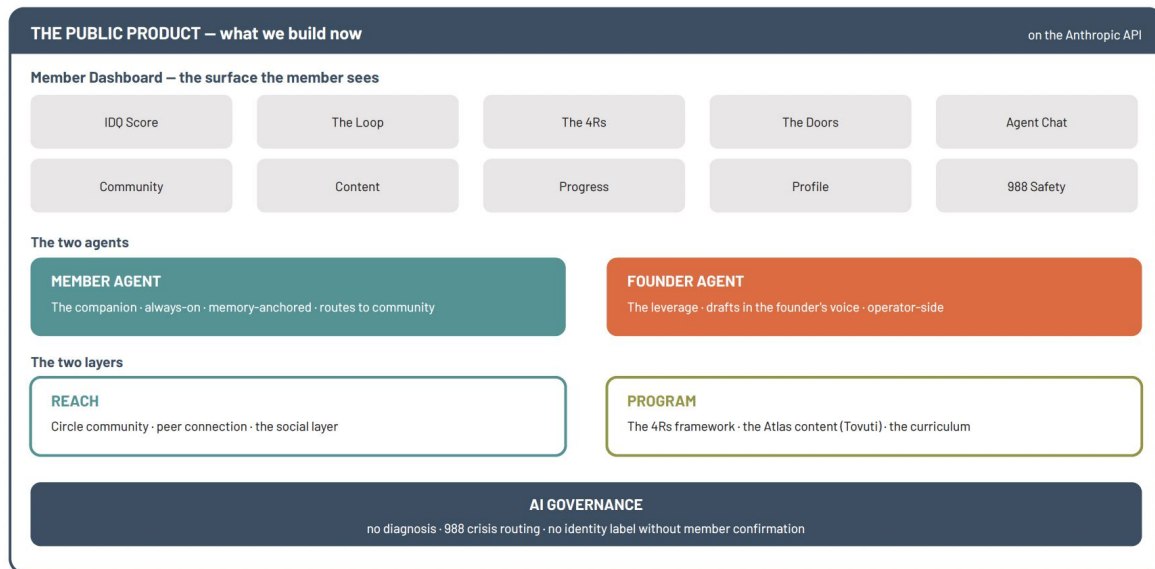


Technical Architecture

Bringing the G4L Platform to Life.

This is the platform under the hood — purpose-built for this problem, not AI bolted onto an app. What a member experiences is simple: a dashboard and a companion that guide them through the 4Rs. Made possible by two purpose-built AI agents engineered underneath on a structured data architecture, with governance and privacy designed in from the start. The same platform can later run as private, self-contained versions for a company, switched on only when a customer funds it.

[CLICK FOR EXPANDED VIEW](#)



HORIZON 3 · CORPORATE — added later, only when a customer funds it

Each company gets a private instance: its own Circle community, its own Member Agent configuration, and per-tenant data isolation (SOC2-grade). Built on top of the public product — additive infrastructure, not a day-one build.

No speculative build. A paying employer funds the multi-tenant work when the corporate channel is earned.

■ Structure

■ Reach

■ Program

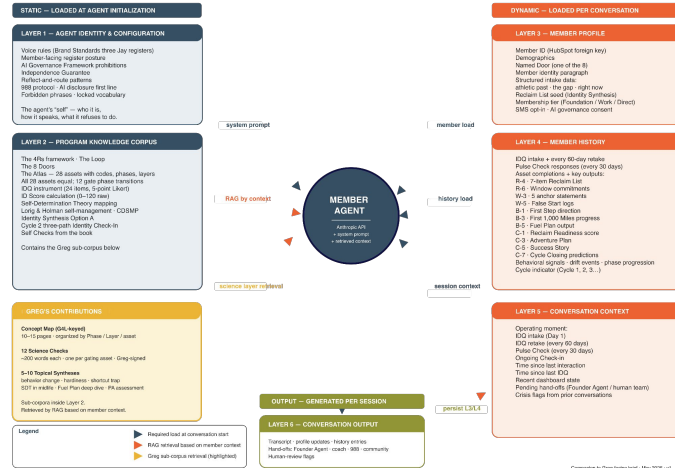
■ Founder Agent

□ Added later (Horizon 3)

Member Agent—The Companion

Bringing the G4L Platform to Life.

The Member Agent – An always-on, private, memory-anchored AI built on the Anthropic API that holds the work between human moments. It remembers every milestone, replaces forms with conversation, and is governed by hard guardrails – no diagnosis, crisis-language routing to 988, and an architecture that pushes members toward real human community rather than replacing it..

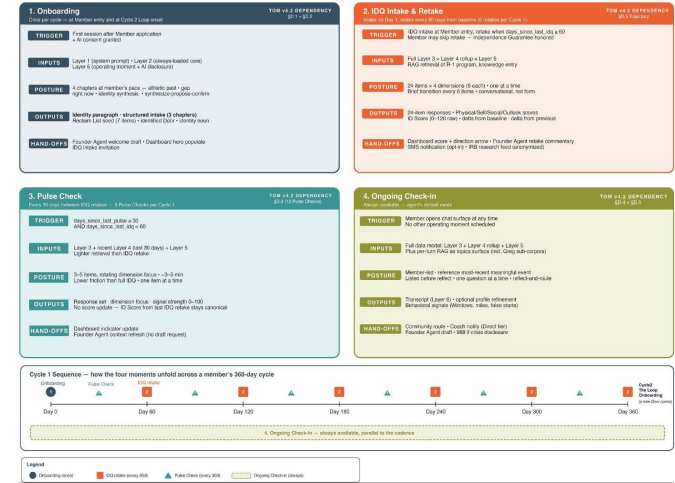


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Member Agent Data Model

This is everything the Member Agent knows when it talks with a member. Six layers feed it — who it is and the program's principles on one side, the member's profile, full history, and the live conversation on the other — so every exchange feels continuous, personal, and grounded in the framework.

MEMBER AGENT TECHNICAL SPECS



[CLICK FOR EXPANDED VIEW](#)

Member Agent Operating Moments

If the data model is what the Member Agent knows, this is what it does. Across a member's 360-day cycle it works in four modes — Onboarding, the IDQ and its 60-day retakes, lighter Pulse Checks in between, and an always-available Ongoing Check-in — each with its own trigger, inputs, and handoffs.

Founder Agent—The Leverage

Scaling the Founder's voice and reach.

The Founder Agent –
The operator-side AI that lets a small, dedicated team deliver a high-touch program at real scale – drafting personalized member correspondence in the founder's voice and surfacing who needs attention. It's how G4L stays personal as it grows, without becoming a faceless platform.



[CLICK FOR EXPANDED VIEW](#)

Founder Agent Data Model

This is everything the Founder Agent knows when it drafts correspondence in Jay's voice. It draws on the member's history plus Jay's own writing corpus and the job that triggered it – and by design, every draft routes to Jay for review before anything is sent. Members never interact with it directly.

FOUNDER AGENT TECHNICAL SPECS



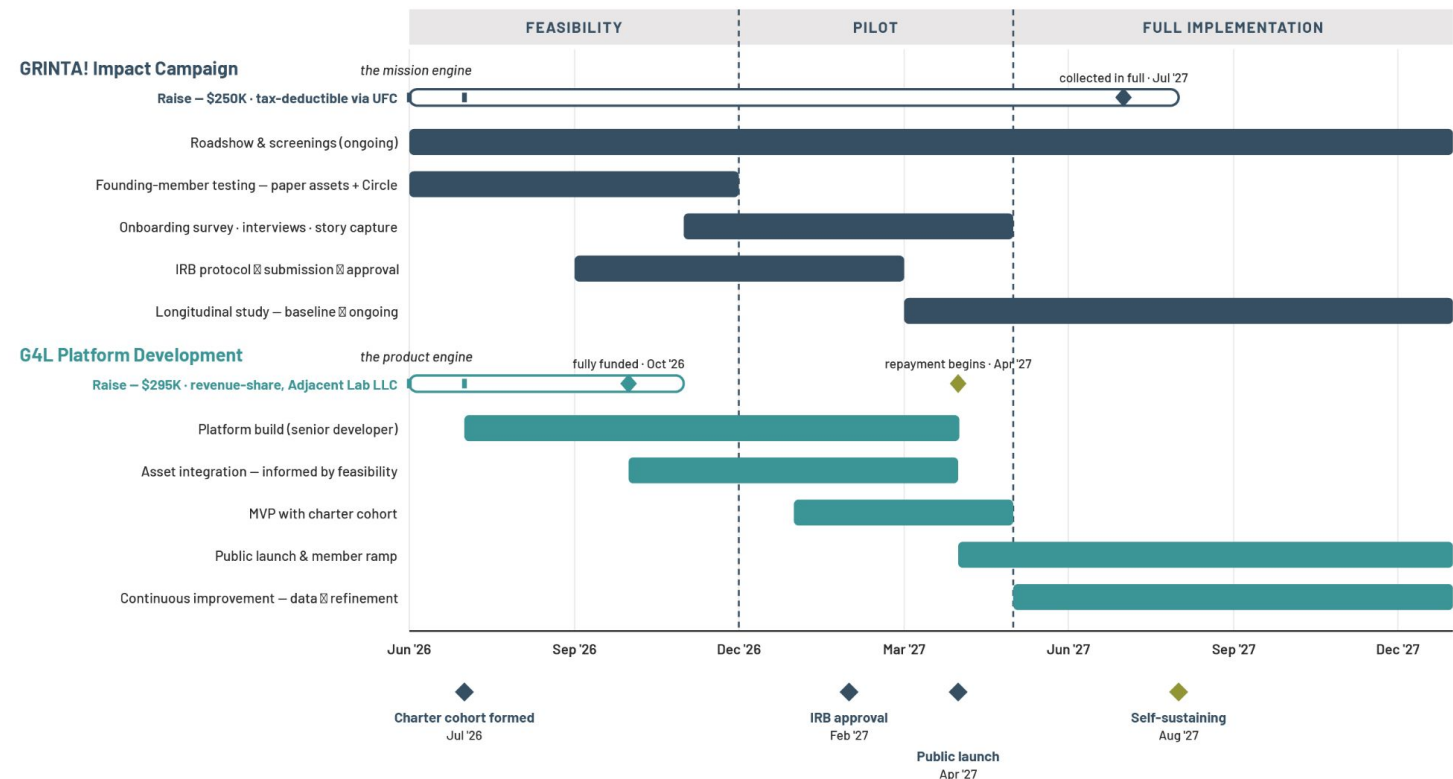
[CLICK FOR EXPANDED VIEW](#)

Founder Agent Operating Moments

If the data model is what the Founder Agent knows, this is what it does. A set of moments – welcomes, milestones, retake commentary, drift re-engagement, and an always-on ambient mode – each trigger a draft in Jay's voice, and every one passes through Jay's review before it goes out through HubSpot.

Development & Evaluation Timeline

Feasibility to Pilot to Full Implementation—June 2026 to December 2027



Capital rails show the v5.0 schedule: revenue-share closes Jun/Jul/Oct '26 (\$75K+\$120K+\$100K); impact campaign collects \$250K through Jul '27; repayment begins Apr '27, reaching \$113K by May '29. v1.2 — proposed for discussion. Dates anchored to Pro Forma v5.0 (build Jul '26 – Mar '27; self-sustaining Aug '27). Charter members participate free through Feasibility and Pilot.

Competitive Landscape

While the longevity and healthspan market is crowded, well-funded, and growing fast, midlifers losing their identity is largely ignored. The longevity space is focused on optimization—sleep, supplements, biohacking. **Nobody else is asking *why* 35 million Americans are losing themselves in the first place.**

How we'll differentially make the biggest impact:

PROGRAM

Proprietary midlife identity framework. The 4Rs, the Doors, the Loop. We start at identity — where others start at symptoms or optimization.

MEASUREMENT & LONGITUDINAL STUDY

The Identity Distance Questionnaire (IDQ) and ID Score, the hero metric that drives retention. IRB-certified study closes a research gap.

GOVERNED AI

The Member Agent (*the companion*) and the Founder Agent (*the leverage that lets a small team stay personal at scale*), built on Anthropic API.

FOUNDERS (BUILDER & SCIENTIST)

A lived, named *founder* and a *film*. GRINTA! and the *book* are a front door no competitor has. Backed by Dr. Welk's lifetime of work that can't be replicated.

COMMUNITY

Midlife peers in the same chapter of life that *get you*, not a general-purpose app. Offers support, accountability, and connection.

G4L Competes Across Six Categories

Midlife-specific transformation • AI mental wellness companions • AI journaling and self reflection apps • Founder-led legacy personal development empires • Adjacent therapy-substitute and premium health services • Corporate Wellness

PLATFORM	Midlife Focus	Identity Work	Athletic Community	AI Agent	Science Partner	Measurement System	Accessible Pricing
BetterUp	X	X	X	✓	✓	X	X
Flourish	X	X	X	✓	✓	X	✓
Headspace	X	X	X	•	X	X	✓
Calm	X	X	X	X	X	X	✓
Noom	X	X	X	✓	X	X	•
WHOOP	X	X	X	✓	X	✓	X
Oura	X	X	X	✓	X	✓	X
Athletica.ai	X	X	X	✓	X	X	✓
Peloton	X	X	•	X	X	X	X
ZOE Health	•	X	X	✓	✓	X	X
Strava	X	X	•	X	X	X	✓
Hinge Health	X	X	X	✓	X	X	X
Modern Elder Academy	✓	✓	X	X	✓	X	X
Brené Brown / Courage Works	X	✓	X	X	✓	✓	X
Midi Health	✓	X	X	X	✓	X	X
Function Health	•	X	X	✓	X	✓	X
Liven	X	X	X	✓	X	X	✓
Apple Health+	X	X	X	✓	X	X	✓
GRINTA FOR LIFE ★	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

Traction gained from six years of work has produced the G4L foundation.

Six years of founder commitment — \$115K self-funded since 2020. Four FTE-years from Donna without compensation. The work pre-dates the raise.

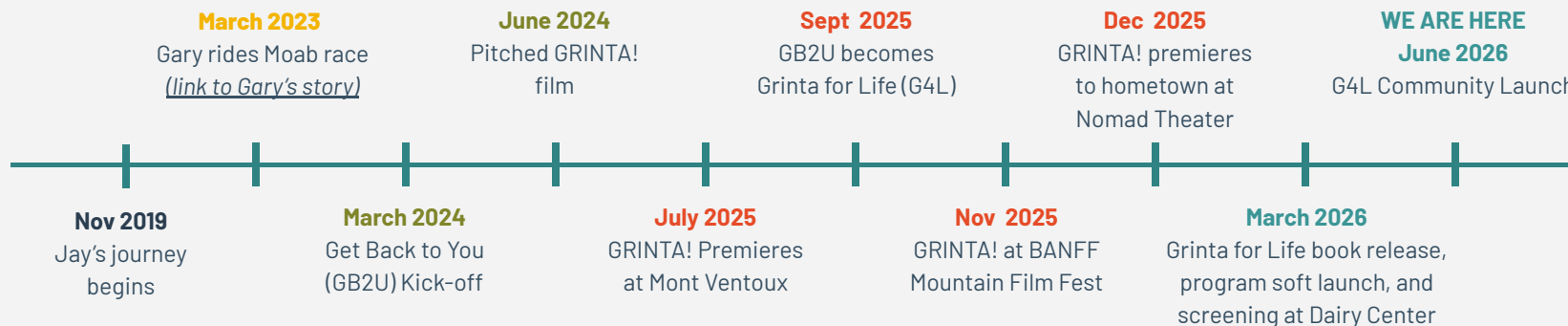
A film at five festivals — BANFF, Big Bike, Bicycle Film Festival, Veneto, and VIMFF. A finished asset that audiences pay to see.

A book in its second edition — Co-authored with Dr. Greg Welk. Delivers June 2026.

A framework anchored in published science — The 4Rs map to Self-Determination Theory (Deci & Ryan) and Lorig & Holman's self-management model. IDQ 24-item psychometric instrument.

A live Member cohort — Soft launch at the Dairy Center, March 2026. People walked out of the screening, lined up around the table, and signed up. The market said yes before we asked.

How we got here The film became a book. The book is becoming a movement.



GRINTA! film

5 Festivals—19% acceptance rate (10% is good)
(2 left to hear from)



Through May 2026
Live views **9,000**
All views **9,100**
Total screenings **80**
Sold out screenings **50**
5 countries

Upcoming June through December 2026
Australia, Belgium, Netherlands, Scotland, US
Additional scheduled screenings **100**

Mailing list sign ups >300
Trips sold at screenings 1 confirmed, 5+ prospects

**GRINTA
FOR LIFE.**

Press

road.cc	2.7M monthly unique visitors drove <i>29,000 impressions of trailer</i>
L'EQUIPE	>200,000 daily readership
La Gazzetta dello Sport	1.5M (print) and 3.4M (digital) daily readers
Velo	811,000 monthly visitors
AFP/France24	>19M monthly visitors
FranceBleu (radio)	49K unique daily visitors
Fausto newsletter	
The Cycling Podcast	70,000 weekly listeners
rennrad-news.de	1.29M monthly visits
Bicycling Magazine	5,000 video views
Yahoo	150M monthly readers
KGNU radio	40,000

Social

Grinta film Instagram
100,000 views/impressions
July 2025 - May 2026

IG Accounts/Followers:
Bicycle Film Festival 466k
BANFF 68k
VIFF 48k
Bicycling Magazine 213k
Big Bike Film Night 2k
Rapha Boulder 3k
R ve de V lo 3,500 + email
Bill Strickland 5,600
Velo Tom 23k
Eros Poli 4k
inGAMBA 28k



Go-to-market—how we'll build our membership

Driving toward **1,200 members in 3 years** out of a TAM of 35 Million

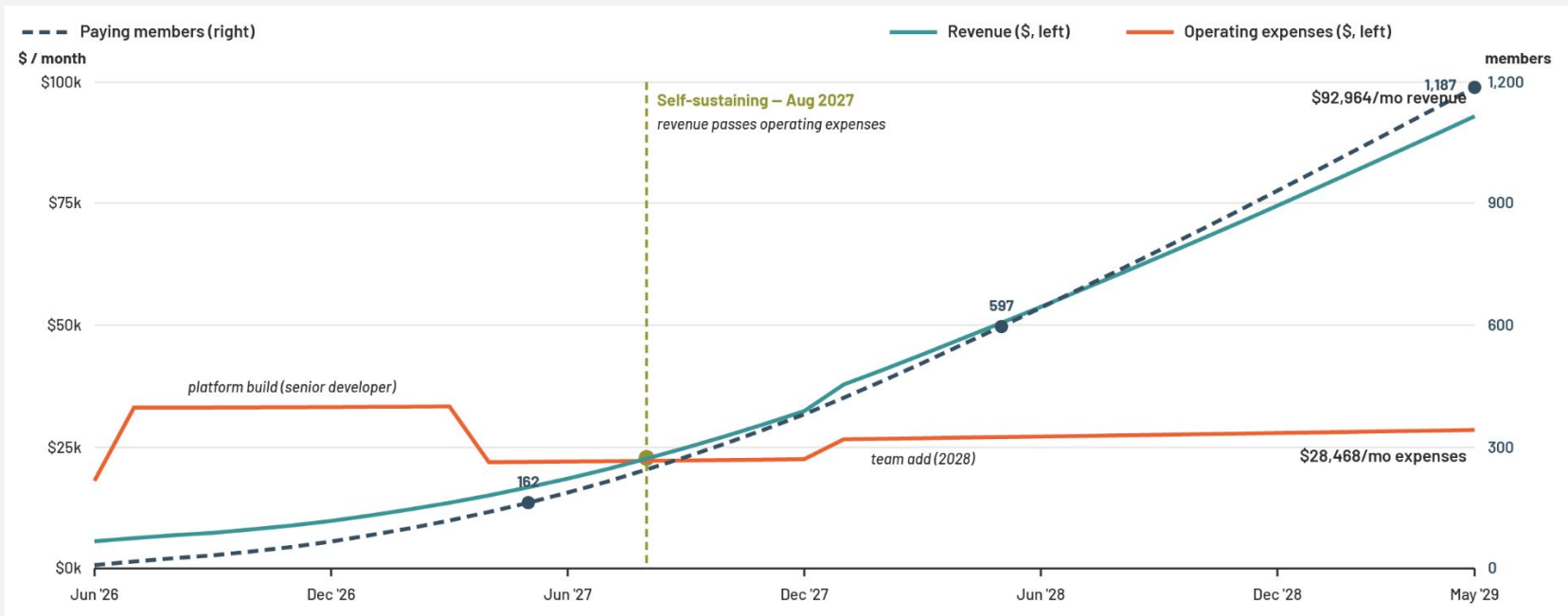
The six channels of our modern marketing matrix work together to build an **authentic, valuable community that grows by its own momentum**. *Podcast interview marketing* leads and drives awareness with credibility. *Social media* builds daily presence. The *newsletter* turns the flywheel weekly. *Screenings* create high-conversion moments. *PR* elevates the narrative to a cultural moment. *Referrals* turn members into ambassadors.

Multi-channel Acquisition Engine

CHANNEL	PURPOSE
Podcast Interview Appearances	Primary. Highest reach and depth. Creates weeks of content. Jay appears on 28 targeted shows.
Social Media	Daily awareness and community
Newsletter Email	Weekly newsletter connecting every element of the marketing matrix
Screenings	High-conversion through GRINTA! events
PR & Earned Media	Media coverage, speaking engagements
Refer a Friend	Member referral program with incentives

Snapshot

Membership, revenue, and operating expenses. June 2026 - May 2029



Business revenue = subscriptions + sponsorships. Excludes impact campaign funds and revenue share capital.

Expenses flat by design – AI is the only cost that scales (~\$2.50/member/mo); hires are milestone-gated; no paid marketing
 Expense stress (2x AI + extra hire + fees): self-sustaining slips Aug → Oct 2027; margin still \$51k/mo at Year 3
 Demand stress (60% of planned signups, higher churn): self-sustaining Apr 2028; cash-positive throughout
 Both at once: a ~\$20k cash dip in mid-2028 – covered by a small buffer within the \$545k raise

The Ask—Two ways to help

We will leverage an innovative, market-driven business model prioritizing positive societal impact, balancing revenue generation with our mission-driven goal of extending healthspan for U.S. midlifers

GRINTA! Impact Campaign \$250k	G4L Platform Development \$295k
What it funds The roadshow, validation of the framework, drive awareness for formation (recruit) of the community starting with the Charter Member Program and kicking off IRB-certified longitudinal study.	What it funds The technical architecture, building the Member Agent and Founder Agent.
How you give A tax-deductible donation through Utah Film Center, a 501(c)(3) film nonprofit and our fiscal sponsor.	How you invest A revenue-share or small founder-friendly convertible into Adjacent Lab LLC, returned from subscription revenue.
What you get A charitable deduction and an onscreen producer credit (Co-Executive Producer at \$10k, Associate at \$5k, Special Thanks at \$1k).	What you get Your capital returned from revenue over time, plus founding-backer standing in the company.
The number A \$250k campaign, already live — with a near-term ~\$80k founding tranche that gets the next wave of screenings and the team in motion now.	The number ~\$295k: about \$220k builds the product over 6–9 months (a senior developer on the Anthropic API, single-tenant), plus a \$75k operating reserve that carries the plan through a slower-growth downside.
Use of funds Venues and marketing, platform tooling and software, member acquisition and content, legal, accounting, insurance, founder compensation, and recoupment, UFC fees, operating reserve	Use of funds Platform development, member acquisition and content, legal, accounting, insurance, founder compensation, operating reserve

—*GRAZIE*—

**GRINTA
FOR LIFE.**

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